

Textual

Organising diagrams



In this module, you are learning to make your writing coherent and cohesive. To help you organise your ideas, some organising diagrams are provided. Assessment 3 is fundamentally a comparative analysis. The diagrams may prove helpful for your other diploma subjects.

1. Read the diagrams in the PowerPoint slides, which illustrate ways of organising your ideas.
2. Check your understanding of the organisation of a generic piece of writing by doing an activity.



Readings



Essential: Organising diagrams

Look at the PowerPoint slides, which provides you with some diagrams to organise your ideas.

Organising diagrams PowerPoint slides

(<https://canvas.utscollege.edu.au/courses/7983/files/4359958?wrap=1>)

↓ (https://canvas.utscollege.edu.au/courses/7983/files/4359958/download?download_frd=1)

Slide 2 provides you with an overview of the generic structure of an essay or report.

1. The introduction (about 10% of the word count) has the following:
 - general statement - background information about the topic.

- (definition) sometimes it is important to define a key term *The term..... in this essay has been defined as ...*
 - thesis statement - your argument. It's a good idea to briefly provide a counterargument. *Although Smith (2104) has argued that...., this report argues that*
 - points to be argued - (outline) *This report first examines before moving on to..... The final part*
 - (findings)
2. The introduction is followed by the body paragraphs, whose order follows the points in the introduction. Each paragraph has **some** of the following:
- Topic sentence
 - elaboration of topic sentence
 - evidence + in-text citation
 - examples
 - explanations
 - analysis
 - implications
 - interpretations
 - evaluations
 - illustrations
 - Summary and link to the next paragraph
3. Each final statement in each of the body paragraph is synthesised into the conclusion, which
- restates the main aim *This essay has argued that*
 - summarises - identify the main reasons/causes/factors that relate to the question you have been asked to address.
 - gives an overall position
 - (recommendations, limitations, future research)

Slide 3 compares and contrasts different genres.

Slide 4 compares a comparative analysis essay to an argument essay.

Slide 5 compares a discussion essay to a problem/solution essay.

Slide 6 provides you with more organising diagrams; these are also good for note-taking.



Check your understanding

Generic structure

Check your understanding of the generic structure of an essay by doing the following activity.

Drag the word into the correct box to complete the summary.

It's a good idea to read the summary first.

Drag the words into the correct boxes

The _____ has a general statement, a _____ statement, points to be _____ and sometimes some _____. The order of the _____ paragraphs follows the same order as that of _____ the _____ in the introduction. Paragraphs generally start with a _____ sentence, and then this topic sentence is _____. Evidence, examples, and _____ are given. The final sentence _____ the information of the paragraph and _____ to the next paragraph. The conclusion _____ the findings, restates the main aim, summarises and provides an overall _____.

points

thesis

links

elaborated

position

introduction

body

synthesises

findings

argued

topic

explanations

distils

✔ Submit

↺ Reuse

I am confused 🚩

Questions & Answers

Organising diagrams

If you have any questions, or would like to discuss answers, please post in the

Textual Module: Q&A Discussion Forum

(https://canvas.utscollege.edu.au/courses/7983/discussion_topics/198365)